

What Was the Requirement?

On paper, the requirement looked simple – prepare for ZATCA Phase 2. In reality, it was far more complex. Invoices originated from multiple independent systems: retail stores through Oracle Retail POS, online orders through a different journey, and ERP systems managing another part of the business. Every system handled data differently, but all had to comply with the same regulatory requirements.

The scale made the challenge bigger still – up to 54 million B2C invoices and around 250,000 B2B invoices every year, all without slowing down operations or affecting customer experience. The engagement also involved a Wave 1 entity, with no previous implementation references to follow. Retail-specific scenarios – promotions, offers, and discount structures – added another layer of complexity requiring careful ZATCA assessment.

The Consequences It Had

No single compliance view

Different systems generated invoices independently, making it difficult to monitor compliance across the business.

High operational complexity

Millions of invoices needed to be processed accurately without affecting business performance.

Implementation uncertainty

As a Wave 1 entity, there was no previous benchmark to follow, making planning and regulatory interpretation even more critical.

Risk of inconsistent compliance

Different business units and systems could interpret regulatory requirements differently if not managed through a unified approach.